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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

Name: Anonymous Anonymous

General Comment

See attached file(s)

Attachments

aiopencomment2025

Re: National Science Foundation's Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

I am an American who works as an artist and cartoonist, including in the public arts and entertainment industries. I have worked hard for years and gotten a MFA to develop the skills and knowledge to build my business, and have been lucky enough to make a decent living – until recently.

The GenAI systems made by Big Tech companies like OpenAI (Microsoft) and Google threaten to destroy thousands of American small businesses like mine with their recent demand to create special carveouts in copyright law.

AI systems can only function by first training on work made by people. My unique work, and the work of hundreds of thousands of other creators was taken and fed into these AI systems without our knowledge, consent, or any compensation. They ingest our work, reassemble it, and then sell it back to our clients – directly competing with us and cutting us out of the marketplace. I personally have lost work due to clients who would rather have a machine imitate my style by STEALING from me first!

Now these Big Tech companies are asking this administration to create exceptions to make this practice of stealing American creators' copyrighted work legal precedent. They are suggesting that if a machine ingests and reproduces copyrighted work, it is somehow suddenly "fair use". They seem to believe that anything and everything on the internet – regardless of who owns it, who created it, or how personal or private that information or image is! – should be theirs for the taking. They claim that if this administration does not allow them to rewrite the law in this way, it will stifle American innovation. They are wrong.

Instead, it will have the opposite effect. The purpose of American copyright law is to protect the incentive to create and innovate, and to ensure that creators are able to benefit from their hard work.

If we the American people do not own our creations, and everything we put online will be stolen by Big Tech, what will be the incentive to create? If everyday Americans create a new innovative piece of computer code, a new visual design, or a new piece of music only to have it immediately stolen by Google and Microsoft, why bother creating it in the first place? Certainly why bother sharing it online? In an industry where online marketing is basically required, we will have no options for getting our work in front of people, and social media websites and the internet at large will be abandoned by creatives. How will we possibly make a living doing these things?

Want to protect American innovation? Protect American creators. **Do not create new copyright exemptions that allow Big Tech companies to exploit and steal from creators and Americans without permission, compensation, or transparency.**

At a bare minimum, any AI Action Plan should ensure that creators can decide whether or not our work is used by AI systems. Big Tech companies should be transparent about where their training data comes from, and should give compensation to the people they take from. There should be options for people whose data has already been scraped to opt out and have their data deleted from these datasets if they choose. Big Tech companies should be also required to label what content is AI generated.

We should not sacrifice the hard work of hundreds of thousands of Americans and give it away to Big Tech by rewriting copyright law. This document is approved for public dissemination. The document

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